

TITLE PAGE

Title

Effects of Dark Chocolate and Oats Sticks on Anxiety, Blood Pressure, and Heart Rate among Adolescents: A Quasi-Experimental Study

Running Title

Dark Chocolate and Oats Reduce Anxiety

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Dear Editor-in-Chief,

We would like to submit our manuscript entitled **“Effects of Dark Chocolate and Oats Sticks on Anxiety, Blood Pressure, and Heart Rate among Adolescents: A Quasi-Experimental Study”** for consideration for publication in the Journal of Nutrition and Food Security.

This study investigates the effects of a functional food–based intervention using dark chocolate and oats sticks on anxiety levels and cardiovascular responses among adolescents. The findings demonstrate that this intervention significantly reduces anxiety, blood pressure, and heart rate, highlighting its potential as a simple and accessible non-pharmacological strategy in adolescent health promotion and preventive programs. We believe that this topic aligns well with the scope of the journal, particularly in the areas of nutrition, functional foods, and public health.

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. All authors have approved the final version of the manuscript and agree with its submission to this journal.

We also confirm that the study was conducted in accordance with ethical standards and received ethical approval (No. 80/STIKES-NH/KEPK/II/2021). The authors declare that there are no conflicts of interest related to this work.

Thank you for your time and consideration. We look forward to your favorable response.

Sincerely,

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(On behalf of all authors)

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